

# Katherine Thomas

Updated: September 2026

✉ [katethomas@nyu.edu](mailto:katethomas@nyu.edu)  
🌐 [katherineathomas.github.io](https://katherineathomas.github.io)  
🌐 [Google Scholar](#)

New York University  
Department of Sociology  
79 Washington Square East  
New York, NY, 10003

## EDUCATION

---

Exp. 2027      Ph.D., Sociology, New York University  
Advanced Certificate in Social Data Science  
*Committee:* Jacob Faber (chair), Michael Hout, Maria Abascal, Ingrid Gould Ellen  
2025            M.A., Sociology, New York University  
2017            B.A., High Honors in Statistics and Policy Studies, Rice University

## PEER-REVIEWED PUBLICATIONS

---

2026            **Thomas, Katherine A.**. “Countering the Current: Flood Risk and Uneven Patterns of Immobility.” *Demography*. [[Paper](#)]  
• Honorable Mention — 2025 SSSP Division of Environment and Technology’s Graduate Student Paper Prize  
• Honorable Mention — 2025 ASA Section on Race, Class and Gender Graduate Student Paper Award  
2026            **Thomas, Katherine A.**, Thomas Storrs, Wenfei Xu, and Jacob W. Faber. “New-deal mortgage programmes benefited white borrowers disproportionately.” *Nature*. [[Paper](#)] [[Summary](#)] [[Data](#)]  
2022            Hanson, Devlin, Michael Pergamit, Laura Packard Tucker, **Katherine A. Thomas**, and Shannon Gedo. “Do Education and Training Vouchers Make a Difference for Youth in Foster Care?” *Child and Adolescent Social Work Journal*.  
2019            **Thomas, Katherine A.**, James R. Elliott, and Sergio Chavez. “Community Perceptions of Industrial Risks Before and After a Toxic Flood: The Case of Houston and Hurricane Harvey.” *Sociological Spectrum*.

## MANUSCRIPTS UNDER REVIEW AND IN PROGRESS

---

Xu, Wenfei, Thomas Storrs, Jacob W. Faber, and **Katherine A. Thomas**. “Revisiting the Measurement of Historical Redlining: Comparative Evidence from FHA and HOLC Maps”

## WORK IN PROGRESS

---

**Thomas, Katherine A.**. “Moving to Risk: The Effect of Climate Risk Information on Residential Mobility and Spatial Inequality.” (Draft available upon request)

Faber, Jacob W., **Katherine A. Thomas**, Thomas Storrs, and Wenfei Xu. “The Geography of Exclusion: Explaining racial disparities in FHA and VA lending”

**Thomas, Katherine A.**, Max Besbris, John Kuk, and Ariela Schachter. “Flooding, Rents, and Redevelopment: The Impact of Floods on Asking Rents.”

Ali, Omer, Jacob W. Faber, Andreas Ferrara, Jonathan Rose, Thomas Storrs, **Katherine A. Thomas**, Gabrielle Toborg, Randall Walsh, and Wenfei Xu (*Authors listed alphabetically*). “The Evolution of Redlining, 1935–75”

## PUBLIC SOCIOLOGY AND SCHOLARSHIP

---

- 2023 [Labor Markets in Climate Migrant Receiving Communities](#). Urban Institute.
- 2023 [Keeping Families Together in New Jersey: Findings from Program Model Interviews](#). Urban Institute.
- 2023 [Evaluation of the Urban Alliance High School Internship Program](#). Urban Institute.
- 2022 [Do Education and Training Vouchers Make a Difference for Young Adults in Foster Care? A Study of Ten States](#). Urban Institute.
- 2021 [Employers, Young People, Training and Support: Implementation Study of the Urban Alliance High School Internship Program](#). Urban Institute.
- 2021 [What Elements of Employment and Training Programs Set Young People up for Success?](#) *Urban Wire*.
- 2020 [What HUD’s Proposed Rule Gets Wrong About Affordable Housing](#). *Urban Wire*.
- 2020 [HUD Omits Race from Fair Housing Proposal: Public Comment on the Proposed Rule Change on Affirmatively Furthering Fair Housing](#). *Public comment submitted to HUD*.
- 2020 [A State-by-State Look at Children of Immigrants](#). Urban Institute.
- 2017 [How to Better Understand Houston’s Complex Network of Parks](#). *Urban Edge*.

## FELLOWSHIPS, GRANTS, AND AWARDS

---

### *External Fellowships and Grants*

- 2025–27 National Science Foundation, “Collaborative Research: Uncovering the history of redlining with new data from local land records.” With Omer A. Ali, Jacob Faber, Andreas Ferrara, Jonathan Rose, Thomas Storrs, Randall P. Walsh, and Wenfei Xu. \$599,996. (Role: Co-Investigator) (Terminated)
- 2023–25 Washington Center for Equitable Growth, “Missing Pieces in the Puzzle: Leveraging untapped archival data to connect New Deal housing policies to racial and spatial inequality.” With Jacob Faber, Thomas Storrs, and Wenfei Xu. \$70,000 (Role: Co-PI)
- 2023–25 Russell Sage Foundation, “Missing Pieces in the Puzzle: Leveraging untapped archival data to connect New Deal housing policies to racial and spatial inequality.” With Jacob Faber, Thomas Storrs, and Wenfei Xu. \$199,681 (Role: Co-Investigator)
- 2022 Summer Institute in Computational Social Science (SICSS), Duke University. (Role: Participant)

*Grant Proposals Under Review*

- 2026 National Science Foundation, “Collaborative Proposal: AI-Driven Digitization of Historic Land Records.” With Omer A. Ali, Jacob Faber, Andreas Ferrara, Jonathan Rose, Thomas Storrs, Gabrielle Toborg, Randall P. Walsh, and Wenfei Xu. \$503,963. (Role: Co-Investigator)

*Competitive Internal Fellowships and Grants*

- 2026–27 NYU Climate Seed Grant, “How Information about Climate Risk Shapes Housing Markets.” With Malcolm Araos. \$19,373. (Role: Co-Investigator)
- 2026 NYU Sociology Research Initiation Grant. \$3,000.
- 2026–28 NYU REBOOT, “Leveraging Historical Property Records to Uncover Federal Support of Redlining.” With Jacob Faber. \$248,524. (Role: Co-Investigator)
- 2025–26 NYU Climate Doctoral Fellowship. \$2,500.
- 2024–25 NYU Institute for Human Development and Social Change, “Financing American Apartheid: Leveraging historical property records to measure the true impacts of redlining.” With Jacob Faber. \$15,070. (Role: Co-Investigator)
- 2023–24 NYU Urban Doctoral Fellowship. \$3,000.
- 2021–26 NYU Henry MacCracken Fellowship for Graduate Study
- 2017–18 Rice University Wagoner Fellowship. \$11,000.
- 2016 Rice University Chandler-Davidson Research Fund. \$2,000.
- 2016 Rice University Loewenstern Fellowship. \$4,000.

*Awards*

- 2025 Selected, SSSP Division of Environment and Technology’s Graduate Student Paper Prize (*Selected by panel to receive prize, not awarded due to eligibility rules requiring conference attendance*)
- 2025 Honorable Mention, ASA Section on Race, Class and Gender Graduate Student Paper Award
- 2017 Rice University Weber-Durkheim Award for Excellence in Sociology
- 2017 Rice University President’s Honor Roll
- 2017 Rice University Distinction in Research and Creative Works

PRESENTATIONS

---

*Invited*

- 2026 Harvard Sociology Urban Data Lab, Cambridge, MA
- 2025 Rice University Spatial Processes and City Environments Collaborative (Virtual)
- 2024 Federal Reserve Bank of Philadelphia, Philadelphia, PA

*Conferences*

- 2026 Association for Public Policy Analysis and Management (APPAM), Boston, MA  
American Sociological Association (ASA), New York, NY  
Sociological Science Conference, Palo Alto, CA

|      |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
|------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 2025 | Association for Public Policy Analysis and Management (APPAM), Seattle, WA<br>American Sociological Association (ASA), Chicago, IL<br>NBER Linking Historical Data Sources for Small Populations, Cambridge, MA                                                                                  |
| 2024 | Social Sciences History Association (SSHA), Toronto, ON<br>American Sociological Association (ASA), Montreal, QC<br>Population Association of America (PAA), Columbus, OH<br>International Conference on Urban Affairs (UAA), New York, NY<br>Eastern Sociological Society (ESS), Washington, DC |
| 2023 | Association for Public Policy Analysis and Management (APPAM), Atlanta, GA                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
| 2021 | Society for Social Work and Research Conference (SSWR) (virtual)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
| 2019 | National Association for Welfare Research and Statistics (NAWRS) Workshop, New Orleans, LA                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
| 2017 | Stanford Undergraduate Research Conference, Palo Alto, CA<br>Rice University Research Symposium, Houston, TX                                                                                                                                                                                     |
| 2016 | Rice University Research Symposium, Houston, TX                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |

## TEACHING AND MENTORSHIP

---

### *Teaching*

|             |                                                                                           |
|-------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Fall 2026   | Teaching Assistant, NYU, Statistics for Social Research (with Michael Hout)               |
| Fall 2024   | Guest Lecturer, Cornell University, Neighborhood Change in the City: Quantitative Methods |
| Spring 2024 | Teaching Assistant, NYU, Statistics for Social Research (with Ravaris Moore)              |
| Fall 2016   | Teaching Assistant, Rice University, Elementary Applied Statistics                        |

### *Formal Mentorship*

|         |                                                                  |
|---------|------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 2025–26 | PhD Mentor, NYU Research Education and Credentialing Hub (REACH) |
|---------|------------------------------------------------------------------|

## SERVICE

---

### *Disciplinary Service*

|         |                                                                                                                                                                    |
|---------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 2026    | APPAM Session Discussant, “Climate Shocks and the Reallocation of Households and Housing”                                                                          |
| 2026    | APPAM Panel Organizer, “Housing policy for equitable climate adaptation”                                                                                           |
| 2026    | RC28, Program Committee Member                                                                                                                                     |
| 2025–26 | ASA Section on Inequality, Poverty and Mobility, Student Council Member                                                                                            |
| 2025    | APPAM, Panel Co-Organizer, “Beyond the Red Lines: New Directions in the Study of Housing Policy and Racial Inequality” (with Jacob Faber)                          |
| 2025    | SASE, Session Co-Organizer, “Historical and environmental foundations of urban inequality: Insights from new methodological assemblages” (with Jonathan Tollefson) |
| 2025    | PAA, Session Discussant, “Historical Roots of Spatial Inequality”                                                                                                  |

2024 SSHA, Session Co-Organizer, “New Data on the New Deal”  
2024 SSHA, Session Chair, “Inequality and Segregation in US Cities”  
2022 SICSS, Program Assistant  
Occasional Reviewer: *Social Forces, Housing Studies, Research in Social Stratification and Mobility*

*Departmental and Institutional Service*

2025 Co-Organizer, NYU Sociology Race/Ethnicity Workshop (with Linsey Edwards)  
2024 Co-Organizer, NYU Sociology Race/Ethnicity Workshop (with Jacob Faber)  
2023 – 25 Co-Organizer, Institute for Public Knowledge Climate Change Doctoral Working Group (with Nicholas Hoynes)  
2022 –23 Chair, Graduate Student Association, NYU Department of Sociology  
2021 Data Science Champion, Urban Institute  
2019 – 21 Peer Ambassador, Urban Institute  
2018 – 21 Organizer, RCT Methods Group, Urban Institute  
2018 – 21 Organizer, R Users Group, Urban Institute  
2018 – 21 Organizer, Stata Users Group, Urban Institute  
2014 – 17 President and Co-Founder, Rice Urbanists, Rice University

RESEARCH AFFILIATIONS

---

*Institutes*

2023 – Co-Director, [Redlining Lab](#)  
2022 – Doctoral Fellow, NYU Institute for Public Knowledge

*Professional Memberships*

- GSOC-UAW Local 2110 – Graduate Student Union, New York University
- American Sociological Association
  - Section on Inequality, Poverty, and Mobility
  - Section on Community and Urban Sociology
  - Section on Environmental Sociology
  - Section on Race, Class, and Gender
- Association for Public Policy, Analysis, and Management
- Population Association of America

*Other Professional Experience*

2022 Research Assistant, Cash Transfer Lab, New York University  
2019 – 21 Urban Institute, Research Analyst  
2018 – 19 Urban Institute, Research Assistant  
2017 – 18 Wagoner Fellow, Buenos Aires, Argentina (independent research fellowship)  
2015 – 17 Research Assistant, Kinder Institute for Urban Research  
2014 Research Intern, Center for Houston’s Future